The 6:15

SATURDAY · OCTOBER 10, 2026 NO. 24

THE BOARD

CALENDAR · WEEKEND EDITION, CONDENSED

Next 5 days	Today, 12:30p ET: Northwestern hosts Ball State, Homecoming, Ryan Field — result not in as of writing. Tue 10/13: Wells Fargo (confirmed, 7a ET) and JPMorgan (unconfirmed) open Q3 bank earnings. Wed 10/14, 8:30a: September CPI, street consensus ~3.7% headline / 2.4% core **(secondary-source consensus, not a wire survey)**.
Standing	FOMC Oct. 27-28 (Oct. hike odds still near the ~17% cycle low set by the payrolls miss); OPEC+ next meets Nov. 1; Dec. 11 CR and Jan. 10 US-China truce unchanged **(continuity)**; no frontier-AI release, rocket launch, or VC mega-round verified this run — third straight issue skipping this sub-bullet rather than padding it.

METRICS · WEEKEND EDITION, CONDENSED — ALL FRI. 10/9 CLOSES, MARKETS SHUT THROUGH MON.

Oil / rates / dollar	Brent $104.72 (+0.42%) / WTI $91.85 (+0.39%), spread ~$12.9, 4:59p ET settle **(Yahoo's detail panel separately lists a $91.49 WTI print — discrepancy not resolved)**; 10Y 5.24% (+0.01) / 30Y 5.60% (-0.01) / 13-wk bill 4.057% **(no 2Y quote located this run)**; DXY 102.23 (+0.02%).
Equities / vol / gold / gas	S&P 500 7,811.54 (+0.59%), Nasdaq Composite 27,366.17 (+0.64%), VIX 14.84 (-3.70%), gold (Dec. future) $4,216.30 (+1.43%); AAA national retail gas $4.3669/gal today.

HORMUZ COUNTERS

Status	Strait "effectively closed" to commercial shipping (straits.live); CENTCOM-enforced blockade has redirected 133 vessels **(Middle East Eye, single-sourced)**.

Transits	4 on Oct. 4 vs. 85/day pre-crisis baseline (IMF PortWatch) **(first new day posted in ten days, still 13h+ stale)**
Strikes	Near-daily through October (USNI); 11 tankers struck the week ended Oct. 4, most since the war began Feb. 28 (CNBC). Oct. 9: an LPG tanker reportedly struck, IRGC claims it took an "illegal route" **(unconfirmed, straits.live/AAP)**. Attacks have spread beyond the strait to Fujairah and Madinat ash Shamal (Windward).
War-risk / scores	~$10.0M per VLCC transit, ~30x pre-crisis **(figure unchanged, now 16 days stale)**. Crisis Pressure 88/100 "extreme" (transit deviation only); Escalation Forecast 60/100 "high," up from 58 in issue No. 23, 2-of-4 inputs, Brent-WTI forward spread the top driver.

Methodology: transits (PortWatch, lagged by design), strike counts (press aggregation — USNI's 9-plus-2 ship count and CNBC's 11-in-a-week cover different windows and aren't reconciled here), and insurance premia (periodic trade-press estimates, now stale) measure different things over different periods; never averaged or differenced in this brief. All straits.live figures single-sourced.

TRANSACTIONS

Yankees	Swept 3-0 by the Rays in the ALDS, eliminated Oct. 7, 4-3 Gm 3 loss at Yankee Stadium.
Knicks	Fell to 0-2 in the preseason, lost 111-109 to Washington Thursday at MSG.
Northwestern	Hosts Ball State today, Homecoming — in progress/upcoming as of press time.

LEAD

IRAN · HORMUZ · OIL

Trump rules out Iran strikes before Nov. 3 — but the Pentagon is told to finish prepping them, a third carrier is inbound, and Hormuz tankers are being hit at a wartime-high clip anyway

Trump posted on Truth Social Wednesday night that "we will not be attacking Iran at any time prior to the Midterm Elections," while keeping the naval blockade of Iranian ports in place and describing talks with Tehran as "productive." [NEW, fact] That statement follows, rather than reverses, an Axios report that the Pentagon had already instructed US Central Command days earlier to finish preparing for a resumption of "major combat operations" against Iran — a campaign that officials said would include extensive strikes on Iranian energy, infrastructure and nuclear sites, likely conducted jointly with Israel. [fact] No specific strike date was set in that directive, and reporting is split on whether the pledge genuinely takes action off the table before Nov. 3: one Israeli official told Axios the odds of strikes before the election are "not high" but explicitly not ruled out, and the White House and Pentagon say no final decision has been made. [fact/flag, single-sourced via Axios]

The force posture is moving regardless. The USS Theodore Roosevelt and its strike group got underway for the CENTCOM region around Oct. 1, which would bring the US to three carriers in the Middle East at once — joining the USS George HW Bush and USS George Washington already on station — alongside more than 7,000 sailors, 2,000 Marines and the Makin Island amphibious group. [fact] Arrival timing diverges by source: an AP-sourced account citing a US official puts three carriers in theater as early as end of October, while a WSJ-based account puts full arrival closer to end of November. [fact/flag] The US last held three carriers in the Middle East simultaneously in April 2026, itself the first time since 2003 — so the hardware is a genuine escalation signal even if the public rhetoric this week pointed the other way. [read]

In the strait itself, the shooting has not paused for the politics. USNI counted near-daily strikes on shipping through October, and CNBC put the week ended Oct. 4 at 11 tankers struck — the worst stretch since the war began Feb. 28. [fact] Straits.live and AAP reported an LPG tanker hit Oct. 9, with the IRGC claiming the vessel had taken an "illegal route"; that claim is unconfirmed independently. [NEW, fact/flag] Windward separately reported strikes extending beyond the strait proper, to waters near Fujairah and Madinat ash Shamal. [fact] Diplomatically, FM Araghchi says Iran is still reviewing a US counterproposal to its seven-day Hormuz-reopening plan and expects to send a "definitive" response within days; the sides remain stuck on the same point as issue No. 23 left it — Washington wants Iran's nuclear program addressed in any deal, not deferred to later talks. [DEVELOPING, fact]

Read: the carrier buildup and the CENTCOM prep order are the more reliable signal here than this week's no-strike pledge, which is explicitly time-boxed to Nov. 3 and leaves the blockade untouched. For the investor, that argues for treating any post-election calm as provisional. Layer in OPEC+'s Oct. 4 decision to hold November output flat at 31.01mn b/d — the second straight month without an increase, with the group citing both Hormuz-constrained exports and Russian flow limits — and the supply side is already running tight heading into whatever comes after the vote. [fact] Oil's muted Friday move (Brent +0.42%, WTI +0.39%) suggests that tightness and the carrier buildup aren't yet being priced as an escalation risk; the straits.live war-risk premium cited above is itself 16 days stale, a gap between the headline news flow this week and the market's own risk gauge. [read] Watch: Iran's promised response "within days," whether carrier arrivals track the earlier (late-October) timeline or

the later one, and Tuesday's CPI print as the next scheduled catalyst competing for the market's attention.

GEOPOLITICS

OPEC+'s seven-country panel confirmed Oct. 4 that November required production holds at September's level, 31.01mn b/d combined — Saudi Arabia 10.478mn b/d, Russia 9.949mn b/d, Iraq 4.431mn b/d — the second consecutive month without the increase the group had been phasing in before the Hormuz war began. [fact] The group's own framing attributes the pause to both the strait disruption and continued constraints on Russian export flows; the next review is Nov. 1. [fact] No fresh, dated reporting on Russia-Ukraine strikes was located this run **(last refreshed in issue No. 23; not re-used here rather than re-adjectived)** — flagged as a gap rather than filled from memory.

IRAN & HORMUZ

Beyond the carrier and diplomatic threads in the Lead, the week's attack pattern has a specific human-cost data point the Lead didn't carry: Marisks, a maritime-security firm, reported twelve Indian sailors injured Monday (Oct. 5) when a projectile struck the UAE-owned tanker On Peace while transiting the strait. [NEW, fact, single-sourced] The IRGC and allied Pasdaran units have also widened their stated targeting criteria, warning of strikes on any vessel they deem to be taking an "unauthorized" route through the wider Gulf — language straits.live and the Financial Times both tie to the Oct. 9 LPG-tanker claim and the Fujairah/Madinat ash Shamal incidents noted on the Board. [fact] CENTCOM's own blockade enforcement, separate from Iranian strikes, has redirected 133

vessels per Middle East Eye's reporting; that figure has not been corroborated by a second outlet. [flag]

Straits.live's own index describes the strait as "effectively closed" to commercial traffic rather than formally blockaded by Iran, a framing distinct from Tehran's position that it has closed Hormuz outright and Washington's position that vessels are still transiting under naval escort. [fact] A prediction-market contract on a return to normal traffic prices just 1% by Oct. 31 and 18% by Dec. 31 (Polymarket, via straits.live) — sentiment, not a primary source, and both figures should be read as a gauge of trader mood rather than a forecast. [flag]

SPORTS

Yankees	Eliminated: swept 3-0 by Rays, lost Gm 3, 4-3, at Yankee Stadium Oct. 7 on Victor Mesa Jr.'s 6th-inning two-run homer. Season over.
Knicks	0-2 preseason after a 111-109 loss to Washington Thursday at MSG; next game not yet confirmed.
Northwestern	Hosts Ball State today, Homecoming, Ryan Field, ~12:30p ET; enters 3-1 overall, 1-1 Big Ten; result not in as of press time.

Continuity. Weekend edition: Metrics and Calendar condensed per standing weekend rule. Politics, Economics, Business and Technology cut entirely — nothing moved since issue No. 23 that the Lead doesn't already cover (the payrolls/Fed-odds and Nike threads from No. 23 are resolved, not reopened), and no frontier-AI release, rocket launch or VC mega-round was verified this run, third issue running. The Yankees-ALDS and Knicks-preseason-opener threads flagged as pending in No. 23 are concluded/continued here. Watch for next issue: Iran's promised "definitive" response to the US counterproposal; whether carrier arrivals track the late-October or late-November timeline; Tuesday's bank earnings and Wednesday's CPI; Northwestern's result vs. Ball State.

Unverified figures are marked in red above. Single-sourced this issue: the Axios CENTCOM-prep report and Israeli-official timing quote; the 133-vessel CENTCOM-blockade figure (Middle East Eye); the Oct. 9 LPG-tanker strike claim; the On Peace injury report (Marisks); all straits.live Hormuz figures (status framing, Crisis Pressure/Escalation Forecast scores,

war-risk premium, prediction-market odds). WTI's headline $91.85 and detail-panel $91.49 are not reconciled. No 2-year Treasury quote was located this run. Nothing was estimated or filled from memory.